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GROUP SPECIFICATION

Network Functions Virtualisation (NFV) Release 5; Protocols and Data Models; Specification of protocols and data models for Intent Management

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Contents

Intellectual Property Rights 4
Foreword 4
Modal verbs terminology 4
1 Scope 5
2 References 5
2.1 Normative references 5
2.2 Informative references 5
3 Definition of terms, symbols and abbreviations 5
3.1 Terms 5
3.2 Symbols 6
3.3 Abbreviations 6
4 Overview of Intent Management 6
4.1 Introduction 6
5 Definition for Intent Management Service Interface 6
5.1 Introduction 6
5.2 API version 6
5.3 Resource structure and method 7
5.4 Sequence diagrams (informative) 7
5.4.1 Flow of creating an intent 7
5.4.2 Flow of querying intents 8
5.4.3 Flow of updating an intent 8
5.4.4 Flow of deleting an intent 9
5.5 Resources 9
5.5.1 Resource: API versions 9
5.5.2 Resource: NFV intents 9
5.5.2.1 Description 9
5.5.2.2 Resource definition 10
5.5.2.3 Resource methods 10
5.5.2.3.1 POST 10
5.5.2.3.2 GET 11
5.5.2.3.3 PUT 12
5.5.2.3.4 PATCH 12
5.5.2.3.5 DELETE 13
5.5.3 Resource: NFV intent object instance 13
5.5.3.1 Description 13
5.5.3.2 Resource definition 13
5.5.3.3 Resource methods 13
5.5.3.3.1 POST 13
5.5.3.3.2 GET 13
5.5.3.3.3 PUT 14
5.5.3.3.4 PATCH 14
5.5.3.3.5 DELETE 15
5.6 OpenAPI specification for data model of Intents 16
Annex A (informative): Change history 17
History 18

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Foreword

This Group Specification (GS) has been produced by ETSI Industry Specification Group (ISG) Network Functions Virtualisation (NFV).

Modal verbs terminology

In the present document "**shall**", "**shall not**", "**should**", "**should not**", "**may**", "**need not**", "**will**", "**will not**", "**can**" and "**cannot**" are to be interpreted as described in clause 3.2 of the ETSI Drafting Rules (Verbal forms for the expression of provisions).

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1 Scope

The present document specifies a RESTful protocol and data model fulfilling the requirements specified in the ETSI GS NFV-IFA 050 [1] for the intent management service interface integrated with NFV-MANO framework. The present document contains normative OpenAPI representations and, optionally, provisions or informative document descriptions.

2 References

2.1 Normative references

References are either specific (identified by date of publication and/or edition number or version number) or non-specific. For specific references, only the cited version applies. For non-specific references, the latest version of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

Referenced documents which are not found to be publicly available in the expected location might be found in the ETSI docbox.

NOTE: While any hyperlinks included in this clause were valid at the time of publication, ETSI cannot guarantee their long-term validity.

The following referenced documents are necessary for the application of the present document.

[1] ETSI GS NFV-IFA 050: "Network Functions Virtualisation (NFV) Release 5; Management and Orchestration; Intent Management Service Interface and Information Model Specification".

[2] ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013: "Network Functions Virtualisation (NFV) Release 5; Protocols and Data Models; Specification of common aspects for RESTful NFV MANO APIs".

2.2 Informative references

References are either specific (identified by date of publication and/or edition number or version number) or non-specific. For specific references, only the cited version applies. For non-specific references, the latest version of the referenced document (including any amendments) applies.

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The following referenced documents may be useful in implementing an ETSI deliverable or add to the reader's understanding, but are not required for conformance to the present document.

[i.1] ETSI GR NFV 003: "Network Functions Virtualisation (NFV); Terminology for Main Concepts in NFV".

[i.2] OpenAPI™ Specification.

[i.3] ETSI GS NFV-SOL 015: "Network Functions Virtualisation (NFV); Protocols and Data Models; Specification of Patterns and Conventions for RESTful NFV-MANO APIs".

3 Definition of terms, symbols and abbreviations

3.1 Terms

For the purposes of the present document, the terms given in ETSI GR NFV 003 [i.1] apply.

3.2 Symbols

Void.

3.3 Abbreviations

For the purposes of the present document, the abbreviations given in ETSI GR NFV 003 [i.1] apply.

4 Overview of Intent Management

4.1 Introduction

ETSI GS NFV-IFA 050 [1] describes the use cases related to intent management, and specifies the requirements, operations and information model of the intent management interface.

In the context of the present document, intent management is a simplified way (compared with traditional API calls) to consume NFV-MANO services, by formulating only the requirements and constraints, and without specifying which operations are necessary to actually fulfil the requirements and finally be executed by NFV-MANO.

The operations defined for the intent management interface (e.g. create intent object instance operation) are produced by intent handler, and consumed by intent owner, to manage the NFV system through intents. The intent owner is the role who formulates an intent object and intent handler is the role who process the intent object. And in principle, a management entity (e.g. NFVO) could play as intent owner, intent handler, or both roles in different use cases.

In release 5, ETSI GS NFV-IFA 050 [1] only describes the use cases about intents used for managing network services. And thus the intent owner is played by OSS/BSS, and the intent handler is played by Intent Management function, which could be an independent management entity in NFV-MANO, or part of NFVO.

5 Definition for Intent Management Service Interface

5.1 Introduction

This clause defines the RESTful protocol for the intent management service interface, based on the information models defined in ETSI GS NFV-IFA 050 [1].

The operations provided through the intent management service interface are:

- Create Intent Object Instance Operation.
- Update Intent Object Instance Operation.
- Delete Intent Object Instance Operation.
- Query Intent Object Instance Operation.

Subscribe Intent Object Instance Operation, Unsubscribe Intent Object Instance Operation, Negotiate Intent Object Operation and Notify Intent Object Instance Operation as defined in ETSI GS NFV-IFA 050 [1] are not supported in the current version of the present document.

5.2 API version

For the intent management service interface version as specified in the present document, the MAJOR version field shall be 1, the MINOR version field shall be 0 and the PATCH version field shall be 0 (see clause 9.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for a definition of the version fields). Consequently, the {apiMajorVersion} URI variable shall be set to "v1".

5.3 Resource structure and method

All resource URIs of the API shall use the base URI specification defined in clause 4.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2]. The string "nfvintent" shall be used to represent {apiName}. All resource URIs in the sub-clauses below are defined relative to the above base URI.

Figure 5.3-1 shows the overall resource URI structure defined for the intent management service interface.

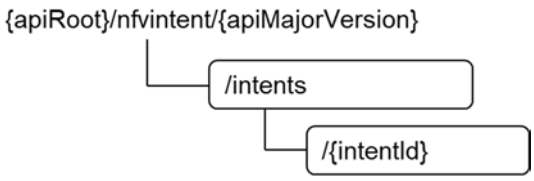


Figure 5.3-1: Resource URI structure of the intent management service interface

Table 5.3-1 lists the individual resources defined, and the applicable HTTP methods. The API producer shall support responding to requests for all HTTP methods on the resources in table 5.3-1 that are marked as "M" (mandatory) in the "Cat" column. The API producer shall also support the "API versions" resources as specified in clause 9.3.2 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].

Table 5.3-1: Resources and methods overview of the Intent management service interface

Resource name	Resource URI	HTTP Method	Cat	Meaning
NFV intents	/intents	POST	M	Create an NFV intent object instance
		GET	M	Query NFV intent object instances
NFV intent object instance	/intents/{intentId}	GET	M	Query a single NFV intent object instance
		PATCH	M	Update a single NFV intent object instance
		DELETE	M	Delete a single NFV intent object instance

5.4 Sequence diagrams (informative)

5.4.1 Flow of creating an intent

This clause describes the sequence for creating an intent.

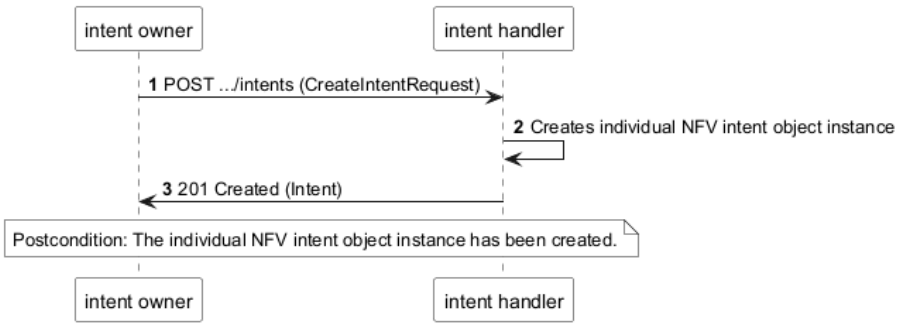


Figure 5.4.1-1: Flow of creating an intent

The intent creation procedure, as illustrated in figure 5.4.1-1, consists of the following steps:

1) The intent owner sends a POST request to the "NFV intents" resource, including one data structure of type "CreateIntentRequest" in the payload body.

2) The intent handler creates an individual NFV intent object instance.

3) The intent handler returns a "201 Created" response with an "Intent" data structure in the body.

Postcondition: Upon successful completion, the individual NFV intent object instance resource has been created.

Error handling: In case of failure, appropriate error information is provided in the response.

5.4.2 Flow of querying intents

This clause describes the sequence for querying multiple or individual intent object instance(s).

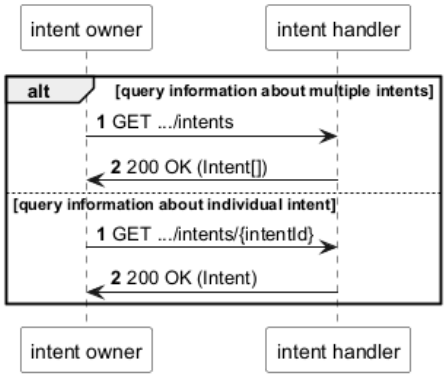


Figure 5.4.2-1: Flow of querying intents

The intent query procedure, as illustrated in figure 5.4.2-1, consists of the following steps:

1) If the intent owner intends to query multiple intents, it sends a GET request to the "NFV intents" resource.

2) The intent handler returns a "200 OK" response to the intent owner, and includes zero or more data structures of type "Intent" in the payload body.

3) If the intent owner intends to query an individual intent, it sends a GET request to the "individual NFV intent object instance" resource, addressed by the appropriate identifier of the intent in its resource URI.

4) The intent handler returns a "200 OK" response to the intent owner, and includes one data structure of type "Intent" in the payload body.

Error handling: In case of failure, appropriate error information is provided in the response.

5.4.3 Flow of updating an intent

This clause describes the sequence for updating an intent.

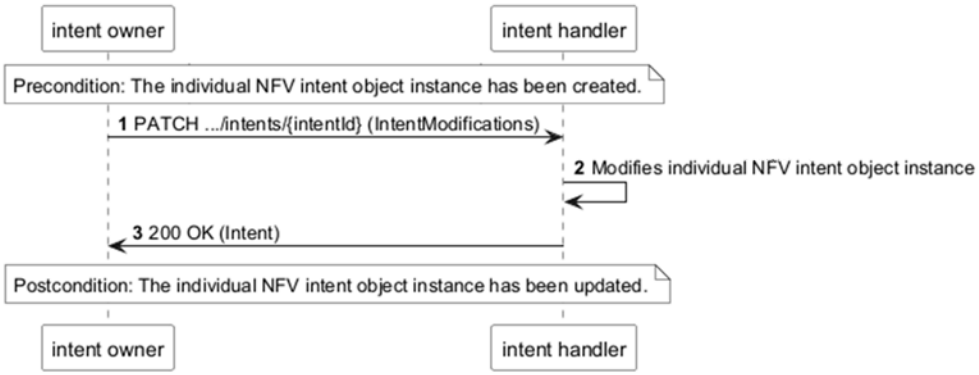


Figure 5.4.3-1: Flow of updating an intent

The intent update procedure, as illustrated in figure 5.4.3-1, consists of the following steps:

1) The intent owner sends a PATCH request to the "individual NFV intent object instance" resource, addressed by the appropriate identifier of the intent in its resource URI, and includes one data structure of type "IntentModifications" in the payload body.

2) The intent handler modifies the individual NFV intent object instance.

3) The intent handler returns a "200 OK" response with an "Intent" data structure in the body to represent the applied modifications.

Postcondition: Upon successful completion, the individual NFV intent object instance resource has been modified.

Error handling: In case of failure, appropriate error information is provided in the response.

5.4.4 Flow of deleting an intent

This clause describes the sequence for deleting an intent.

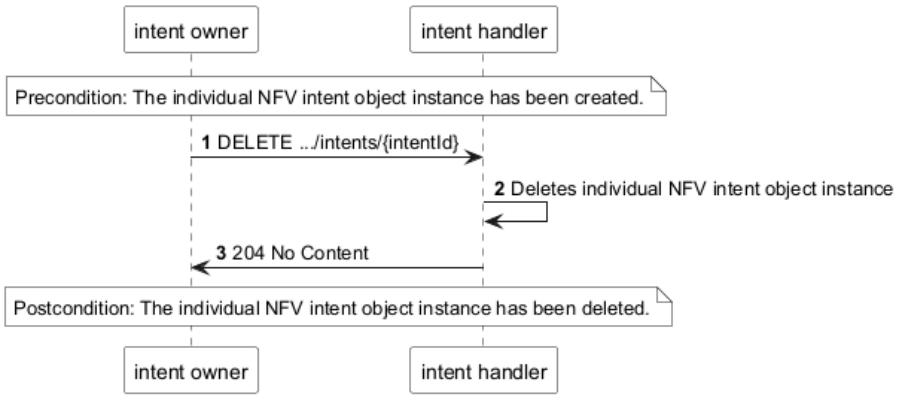


Figure 5.4.4-1: Flow of deleting an intent

The intent deletion procedure, as illustrated in figure 5.4.4-1, consists of the following steps:

1) The intent owner sends a DELETE request to the "individual NFV intent object instance" resource, addressed by the appropriate identifier of the intent in its resource URI.

2) The intent handler deletes the individual NFV intent object instance.

3) The intent handler returns a "204 No Content" response with an empty payload body.

Postcondition: Upon successful completion, the individual NFV intent object instance resource has been deleted.

Error handling: In case of failure, appropriate error information is provided in the response.

5.5 Resources

5.5.1 Resource: API versions

The "API versions" resources as defined in clause 9.3.3 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] are part of the intent management service interface.

5.5.2 Resource: NFV intents

5.5.2.1 Description

This resource represents the NFV intents managed by the intent handler. The API consumer can use this resource to create and query NFV intent object instances.

5.5.2.2 Resource definition

The resource URI is:

{apiRoot}/nfvintent/{apiMajorVersion}/intents

This resource shall support the resource URI variables defined in table 5.5.2.2-1.

Table 5.5.2.2-1: Resource URI variables for this resource

Name	Definition
apiRoot	See clause 4.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2]
apiMajorVersion	See clause 5.2

5.5.2.3 Resource methods

5.5.2.3.1 POST

The POST method creates an NFV intent object instance.

This method shall follow the provisions specified in tables 5.5.2.3.1-1 and 5.5.2.3.1-2 for URI query parameters, request and response data structures, and response codes.

As the result of successfully executing this method, a new "NFV intent object instance" resource as defined in clause 5.5.3 shall have been created.

Table 5.5.2.3.1-1: URI query parameters supported by the POST method on this resource

Name	Cardinality	Description
none supported		

Table 5.5.2.3.1-2: Details of the POST request/response on this resource

Request body	**Data type**	**Cardinality**	**Description**	
	CreateIntentRequest	1	The description of the intent to be created.	
Response body	**Data type**	**Cardinality**	**Response Codes**	**Description**
	Intent	1	201 Created	Shall be returned when an NFV intent object instance has been created successfully. The response body shall contain a representation of the NFV intent, as defined in clause 5.5.3. The HTTP response shall include a "Location" HTTP header that contains the resource URI of the created NFV intent object instance.
	ProblemDetails	See clause 6.4 of [2]	4xx/5xx	In addition to the response codes defined above, any common error response code as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] may be returned.

5.5.2.3.2 GET

The GET method queries information about multiple NFV intents.

This method shall follow the provisions specified in tables 5.5.2.3.2-1 and 5.5.2.3.2-2 for URI query parameters, request and response data structures and response codes.

Table 5.5.2.3.2-1: URI query parameters supported by the GET method on this resource

Name	Cardinality	Description
filter	0..1	Attribute-based filtering expression according to clause 5.2 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2]. The API producer shall support receiving this parameter as part of the URI query string. The API consumer may supply this parameter. All attribute names that appear in the Intent and in data types referenced from it shall be supported by the API producer in the filter expression.
all_fields	0..1	Include all complex attributes in the response. See clause 5.3 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for details. The API producer shall support this parameter.
fields	0..1	Complex attributes to be included into the response. See clause 5.3 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for details. The API producer should support this parameter.
exclude_fields	0..1	Complex attributes to be excluded from the response. See clause 5.3 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for details. The API producer should support this parameter.
nextpage_opaque_marker	0..1	Marker to obtain the next page of a paged response. Shall be supported by the API producer if it supports alternative 2 (paging) according to clause 5.4.2.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for this resource.

Table 5.5.2.3.2-2: Details of the GET request/response on this resource

Request body	Data type	Cardinality	Description	
	n/a			
Response body	**Data type**	**Cardinality**	**Response Codes**	**Description**
	Intent	0..N	200 OK	Shall be returned when information about zero or more intents has been queried successfully. The response body shall contain in an array the representations of zero or more intents. If the "filter" URI parameter or one of the "all_fields", "fields" (if supported), "exclude_fields" (if supported) or "exclude_default" URI parameters was supplied in the request, the data in the response body shall have been transformed according to the rules specified in clauses 5.2.2 and 5.3.2 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2], respectively. If the API producer supports alternative 2 (paging) according to clause 5.4.2.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for this resource, inclusion of the Link HTTP header in this response shall follow the provisions in clause 5.4.2.3 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].
	ProblemDetails	1	400 Bad Request	Shall be returned upon the following error: Invalid attribute-based filtering expression. The response body shall contain a ProblemDetails structure, in which the "detail" attribute should convey more information about the error.
	ProblemDetails	1	400 Bad Request	Shall be returned upon the following error: Invalid attribute selector. In the returned ProblemDetails structure, the "detail" attribute should convey more information about the error.
	ProblemDetails	1	400 Bad Request	Shall be returned upon the following error: Response too big. If the API producer supports alternative 1 (error) according to clause 5.4.2.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] for this resource, this error response shall follow the provisions in clause 5.4.2.2 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].
	ProblemDetails	See clause 6.4 of [2]	4xx/5xx	In addition to the response codes defined above, any common error response code as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] may be returned.

5.5.2.3.3 PUT

This method is not supported. When this method is requested on this resource, the API producer shall return a "405 Method Not Allowed" response as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].

5.5.2.3.4 PATCH

This method is not supported. When this method is requested on this resource, the API producer shall return a "405 Method Not Allowed" response as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].

5.5.2.3.5 DELETE

This method is not supported. When this method is requested on this resource, the API producer shall return a "405 Method Not Allowed" response as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].

5.5.3 Resource: NFV intent object instance

5.5.3.1 Description

This resource represents an individual NFV intent. The API consumer can use this resource to query, modify and delete an NFV intent object instance.

5.5.3.2 Resource definition

The resource URI is:

{apiRoot}/nfvintent/{apiMajorVersion}/intents/{intentId}

This resource shall support the resource URI variables defined in table 5.5.3.2-1.

Table 5.5.3.2-1: Resource URI variables for this resource

Name	Definition
apiRoot	See clause 4.1 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2]
apiMajorVersion	See clause 5.2
intentId	Identifier of the intent object instance. See note.
NOTE: This identifier can be retrieved from the resource referenced by the "Location" HTTP header in the response to a POST request creating a new "NFV instance object instance" resource. It can also be retrieved from the "id" attribute in the payload body of that response.	

5.5.3.3 Resource methods

5.5.3.3.1 POST

This method is not supported. When this method is requested on this resource, the API producer shall return a "405 Method Not Allowed" response as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].

5.5.3.3.2 GET

The GET method queries information about an NFV intent.

This method shall follow the provisions specified in tables 5.5.3.3.2-1 and 5.5.3.3.2-2 for URI query parameters, request and response data structures and response codes.

Table 5.5.3.3.2-1: URI query parameters supported by the GET method on this resource

Name	Cardinality	Description
none supported		

Table 5.5.3.3.2-2: Details of the GET request/response on this resource

Request body	Data type	Cardinality	Description	
	n/a			
Response body	**Data type**	**Cardinality**	**Response Codes**	**Description**
	Intent	1	200 OK	Shall be returned when information about an individual intent object instance has been queried successfully.
	ProblemDetails	See clause 6.4 of [2]	4xx/5xx	In addition to the response codes defined above, any common error response code as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] may be returned.

5.5.3.3.3 PUT

This method is not supported. When this method is requested on this resource, the API producer shall return a "405 Method Not Allowed" response as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2].

5.5.3.3.4 PATCH

The PATCH method modifies an intent.

This method shall follow the provisions specified in tables 5.5.3.3.4-1 and 5.5.3.3.4-2 for URI query parameters, request and response data structures, and response codes.

Table 5.5.3.3.4-1: URI query parameters supported by the PATCH method on this resource

Name	Cardinality	Description
none supported		

Table 5.5.3.3.4-2: Details of the PATCH request/response on this resource

Request body	Data type	Cardinality	Description	
	IntentModifications	1	The modifications for the intent object instance.	
Response body	**Data type**	**Cardinality**	**Response Codes**	**Description**
	Intent	1	200 OK	Shall be returned when the modifications have been processed successfully. The response body shall contain a representation of the updated intent.
	ProblemDetails	0..1	412 Precondition failed	Shall be returned upon the following error: A precondition given in an HTTP request header is not fulfilled. Typically, this is due to an ETag mismatch, indicating that the resource was modified by another entity. The response body should contain a ProblemDetails structure, in which the "detail" attribute should convey more information about the error.
	ProblemDetails	1	422 Unprocessable Content	Shall be returned upon the following error: The content type of the message content is supported and the message content of a request contains syntactically correct data but the data cannot be processed. The general cause for this error and its handling is specified in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2], including rules for the presence of the response body.
	ProblemDetails	See clause 6.4 of [2]	4xx/5xx	In addition to the response codes defined above, any common error response code as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] may be returned.

5.5.3.3.5 DELETE

The DELETE method deletes an individual intent.

This method shall follow the provisions specified in tables 5.5.3.3.5-1 and 5.5.3.3.5-2 for URI query parameters, request and response data structures, and response codes.

As the result of successfully executing this method, the "NFV intent object instance" resource shall not exist any longer.

Table 5.5.3.3.5-1: URI query parameters supported by the DELETE method on this resource

Name	Cardinality	Description
none supported		

Table 5.5.3.3.5-2: Details of the DELETE request/response on this resource

Request body	Data type	Cardinality	Description	
	n/a			
Response body	**Data type**	**Cardinality**	**Response Codes**	**Description**
	n/a		204 No Content	Shall be returned when the individual intent has been deleted successfully. The response body shall be empty.
	ProblemDetails	See clause 6.4 of [2]	4xx/5xx	In addition to the response codes defined above, any common error response code as defined in clause 6.4 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2] may be returned.

5.6 OpenAPI specification for data model of Intents

The OpenAPI specification of the operations compliant to the OpenAPI™ Specification [i.2] defined in the present document can be found at ETSI forge, i.e. https://forge.etsi.org/rep/nfv/SOL021/-/tree/Release-5

The OpenAPI representations referenced above:

1) use the MAJOR.MINOR.PATCH version fields to signal the version of the API as defined in the present document; and

2) use the "impl" version parameter (see clause 9.1.2 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 013 [2]) to represent changes to the OpenAPI representation without changing the present document).

It is specified in clause 6 of ETSI GS NFV-SOL 015 [i.3] how the OpenAPI specification references the present document and signals the version information.

Annex A (informative): Change history

Date	Version	Information about changes
December 2023	0.0.1	First version providing the document skeleton and scope.
June 2025	0.0.2	Incorporate the following contribution: - NFVSOL(25)000101r1_SOL021_Clause_4_Overview
January 2026	0.0.3	Incorporate the following contribution: - NFVSOL(25)000340r1_SOL021_Clause_5_Definition_of_Intent_Management_Resources_an
March 2026	0.0.4	Incorporate the following contributions: - NFVSOL(26)000044_SOL021_Clause_5_4_Sequence_diagrams - NFVSOL(26)000045_SOL021_Editor_s_Notes_Clean-up
April 2026	0.0.5	Incorporate the following contributions: - NFVSOL(26)000116r1_SOL021_Add_OpenAPI
August 2026	0.0.6	Update the figure in clause 5.4.3

History

Version	Date	Status
V5.4.1	September 2026	Publication